STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			G-8300
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 12/04/06	DATE REVISED **03/10/23**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT FIREARMS TRAINING AND QUALIFICATION	CROSS REFERENCE G-6214 SEMI-AUTOMATIC CARBINE			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for firearms training, qualification, and firearms range procedures.

II. Policy:

All deputies shall participate in a regular program of firearms training and shall demonstrate proficiency with approved firearms. Deputies must maintain proficiency as a requirement of employment.

III. Procedure:

A. Lead Firearms Instructor: The Sheriff shall appoint a sergeant or command officer as the Lead Firearms Instructor. The Lead Firearms Instructor shall be a certified firearms instructor and shall function as the liaison between the command staff and the firearms instructors. The Lead Firearms Instructor shall assist the Lead Range Master in the administration of firearms training.

B. Lead Range Master: The Sheriff, with the assistance of the Lead Firearms Instructor, shall appoint a deputy as the Lead Range Master. The Lead Range Master shall be a certified firearms instructor and shall be responsible for the curriculum of training and qualification courses. The Lead Range Master shall also be responsible for the firearms range and Sheriff's Office ammunition.

C. Frequency of Training and Qualification:

1. Duty Handguns: Qualification shall be held at least twice each calendar year to demonstrate deputies' proficiency with their approved duty handguns. A minimum score of 80% must be obtained during each required qualification. Attendance is mandatory. One qualification shall be the required Nebraska State qualification course for semi-automatic handguns.

Per Title 79, Chapter 17.004.01 State Handgun Qualification Course shall not be included in consideration of satisfying the continuing education (CE) requirements. Additional firearm drills must be included when completing the State Handgun Qualification Course in order for it to count towards an employee's CE requirements.

2. Shotguns: Qualification shall be held at least once each calendar year to demonstrate deputies' proficiency with the shotgun. A minimum score of 80% must be obtained during each required qualification. Attendance is mandatory.

3. Semi-Automatic Carbines: Qualification shall be held at least once each calendar year to demonstrate deputies' proficiency with approved carbines. Minimum passing scores shall be determined by a qualified carbine instructor (see G-6214 Semi-Automatic Carbine).

4. Off-duty and Back-up Handguns: Qualification for off-duty and back-up handguns shall be in conjunction with duty handgun qualification. Deputies must qualify at least once per calendar year with any approved off-duty and/or back-up handgun.

5. Additional training may be conducted, including tactical and night shooting.

a) Poor performance at any additional training may result in remedial training.

b) Tactical shooting may include "combat" shooting, unusual shooting positions, multiple targets, training with unloaded weapons, and training with weapon simulators (i.e. simunitions).

c) Night shooting may include firing in total darkness, with illumination (e.g. flashlights, headlights, rotating lights, etc.) or with night vision devices.

D. Firearms Qualification Attendance:

1. All sworn employees must attend all scheduled firearms qualifications and training.

2. If an employee has advanced knowledge that he or she will be unable to attend a firearms qualification, the employee shall send a memorandum to his or her immediate supervisor and the Training Sergeant. The memorandum must include the reason(s) for missing each day of the qualification (If a physician has prohibited an employee from shooting, documentation from the physician explaining the employee's restrictions shall be attached to the memorandum).

3. If an employee is unable to attend a firearms qualification due to unforeseen circumstances, he or she shall personally notify his or her immediate supervisor and the Training Sergeant as soon as possible. Upon return to duty, the employee shall provide the Training Sergeant a memorandum including the reason(s) for missing the firearms qualification.

4. The Training Sergeant shall conduct a review of all sworn personnel who fail to appear for qualification. When the Training Sergeant deems an employee's failure to attend was unexcused, the employee may be subject to disciplinary action.

5. If a sworn employee fails to attend the minimum required qualifications, the Administrative Commander shall forward a recommendation to the Sheriff regarding the employee's employment status.

6. A sworn employee who cannot attend firearms training while on duty shall attend training on a regular day off.

E. Failure to Qualify:

1. Each sworn employee must obtain a passing score of 80% with his or her duty handgun at each scheduled qualification shoot.

2. An employee who fails to qualify on the first attempt shall remain at the range and shall be allowed up to two (2) additional attempts to qualify a duty handgun.

a) If the employee fails to achieve a passing score after the third attempt, the Range Master shall notify the Administrative Commander.

b) The Administrative Commander may place the employee on emergency relief from duty with pay. The Administrative Commander shall make a recommendation to the Sheriff regarding the employee's work status.

c) The employee shall not be allowed to carry a duty handgun until he or she has qualified with that weapon.

3. In order to carry a shotgun, carbine, off-duty handgun, or back-up handgun, deputies must obtain a minimum passing score for each scheduled qualification. If after three (3) attempts to qualify, a deputy is unable to achieve a passing score, the Range Master shall notify the Administrative Commander. The Administrative Commander shall make a

recommendation to the Sheriff concerning the employee's approval to carry the aforementioned firearms.

a) In the case of a failure to qualify with the shotgun, the deputy may be reassigned to a position not required to carry a Sheriff's Office shotgun.

4. Those deputies on limited duty or absent for an extended period (e.g. extended illness, extended leave of absence, leave without pay, or extended military leave) that prevents the officer from participating in the required Nebraska State qualification shall be required to qualify prior to return to full-duty status.

F. Firearms Qualification Procedures:

1. The firearms range shall be staffed by a minimum of three (3) certified firearms instructors for each duty handgun qualification (two (2) instructors shall be required for carbine qualifications). The following positions shall be filled by the assigned instructors:

a) Range Master: The Range Master shall be in sole command of the firearms range in regard to safety and courses of fire.

b) Armorer:

(1) The armorer shall check all weapons brought to the range for any defects, malfunctions, and cleanliness.

(2) The armorer shall make minor adjustments and corrections to weapons. Major repairs shall be brought to the attention of the Range Master and he or she shall make the decision to take the weapon out of service.

(3) The armorer shall have each deputy complete the top portion of a Firing Range Checklist form prior to any attempt at qualification including verifying weapons serial numbers.

(4) The armorer shall complete the Firing Range Checklist to include number of attempts, scores, remedial training provided and any additional comments. The deputy shall verify the score and initial any score that is below passing. Completed checklists shall be retained in a training file.

c) Line Command Officer(s):

(1) The line command officer(s) maintains order and decorum on the firing line.

(2) He or she shall ensure each deputy adheres to the correct course of fire and shall check the scores for each shooter.

G. Firearms Range Use: The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office has exclusive use of the firearms range located at 63rd and Platte River. All employees shall adhere to the following rules for the use of the range.

1. Range Hours: The range is available Monday through Friday from 0800 to 1800 hours. There shall be no firing after 1800 hours. County maintenance (mowing, etc.) shall take precedence over all range activities.

2. Only sworn employees shall be allowed to use the firing range unless specific permission is obtained from the Lead Firearms Instructor or the Lead Range Master. Exceptions shall generally only be made for official Sheriff's Office functions (e.g. weapons demonstrations for the County Attorney's Office).

3. Range ~~Cards~~ Reservation: A Range Reservation must be completed prior to any use of the range (except for scheduled qualifications and training). Any deputy requesting to use the range shall submit a Range Reservation to the Training Sergeant. The Range Reservation shall be completed and forwarded electronically. The Training Sergeant shall ensure the range is available for the requested via the Range Reservation calendar and shall notify the requesting deputy if the request is approved or denied.

H. Range Operation Procedures:

1. During inclement weather the Administrative Commander, the Lead Firearms Instructor, or the Lead Range Master may cancel a scheduled training or qualification. Deputies should contact the Sheriff's Office during inclement weather prior to going to the range.

2. When deputies report to the range, all firearms shall be unloaded and secured in a holster or carrying case. The clearing barrel shall be used to unload weapons prior to entering the range area.

3. Deputies shall only load weapons on the firing line and when instructed to do so by a firearms instructor.

4. While on the range, deputies shall not remove a weapon from a holster or carrying case unless he or she has been instructed to do so by a firearms instructor.

5. Deputies shall report to the range armorer to have his or her weapon(s) inspected to ensure it is unloaded and safe to fire.

6. Deputies shall be responsible for mounting their own targets when instructed to do so by a firearms instructor. Deputies shall also be responsible for picking up their spent brass.

7. Deputies shall not talk while on the firing line while an instructor is giving orders (this does not pertain to the shooter/coach conversations).

8. There is no smoking on the firing line.

9. No one shall leave the firing line without permission.

10. Only firearms instructors shall give range commands.

11. Deputies are responsible for knowing the range commands and course of fire.

12. Vehicles shall be parked in the designated parking area only unless authorized by a firearms instructor.

13. Equipment: Deputies shall have the following equipment when reporting for qualification or training:

a) Required weapon(s).
b) Duty belt and holster.
c) Magazines and magazine holders.
d) Ammunition.
e) Flashlight (if a night shoot).
f) Ballistic Vest: All deputies shall wear a ballistic vest while shooting.

14. Deputies shall ensure that duty handguns are fully loaded with duty ammunition prior to leaving the range.

I. Ammunition Utilization: Employees required to utilize ammunition for training shall adhere to the following procedures:

1. The employee shall submit an Ammunition Request Form to the Lead Firearms Instructor (form may be submitted electronically). The employee shall document the reason for the request (e.g. Basic Academy, Carbine Qualification, etc.) and the amount and type of ammunition requested.

2. The Lead Firearms Instructor or his or her designee shall determine if the ammunition is available.

a) If the ammunition is available, the Lead Firearms Instructor or his or her designee shall make the ammunition available to the requesting employee and shall update the Ammunition Inventory Database. The Ammunition Request Form shall be signed and returned to the Lead Firearms Instructor. Only the Lead Firearms Instructor or his or her designee shall access the ammunition storage and/or remove ammunition.

b) If the ammunition is not available, the Lead Firearms Instructor or his or her designee shall notify the requesting employee and advise him or her that the ammunition will be ordered and that he or she will be notified when it is received.

3. Employees receiving ammunition for training shall return all unused ammunition to the Lead Firearms Instructor. The Lead Firearms Instructor or his or her designee shall return the ammunition to the ammunition storage and update the Ammunition Inventory Database with the amount of the returned ammunition.

4. All ammunition for the Emergency Service Unit shall be stored separately and only the ESU Commander or his or her designee may access the ESU ammunition storage and/or remove ammunition.

J. Firearms Cleaning: The cleaning of a firearm is essential to its proper function. Cleaning materials shall be available at the range for each firearms training and qualification. Deputies shall clean their firearms at the range or prior to their next duty shift.

1. Employees who choose to clean their weapons within the Sheriff's Office shall only do so in the armory.

2. The Sheriff's Office Assembly Room may be utilized when it is necessary for multiple employees (e.g. ESU) to clean their weapons concurrently. Prior to utilizing the Assembly Room for weapon cleaning, the following shall take place:

a) The Administrative Commander shall be notified.
b) A reservation of the Assembly Room shall be documented on the Assembly Room Scheduling Calendar.
c) The partition separating the Assembly Room from the Investigations Conference Room shall remain open, and all doors with access to the Assembly Room shall remain closed.

K. Range Safety Procedures:

1. Every gun shall be treated as if it were loaded.

2. Muzzles shall be pointed down range at all times.
3. Fingers shall be off the trigger until the weapon is pointed at a target.
4. Shooters shall remain aware of the backstop and correct target.
5. Shooters shall obey all commands from firearms instructors.
6. Weapons shall be in safe operating condition with correct ammunition.
7. Running shall not be permitted unless instructed by a firearms instructor.
8. Wrestling, poking, prodding, or touching other shooters is prohibited.
9. Weapons shall remain holstered unless on the firing line.
10. Distracting shooters is prohibited.
11. Dry firing shall not be permitted unless instructed by a firearms instructor.
12. Weapons shall only be passed to another person with the slide or cylinder open.
13. In the event of a misfire, the weapon shall be cleared using proper procedure and firing shall continue. If the weapon cannot be cleared, a firearms instructor shall be notified immediately.
14. No alcohol shall be consumed within eight (8) hours of reporting to the range.

L. **Violations:** Any violation of range operation or safety procedures may result in removal from the range and disciplinary action.